Ihor Zaitsev

Senior / Lead UI/UX Designer

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SUMMARY

I've been designing UI/UX for 9+ years, mostly for mobile products that millions of people use, from free-to-play games like Modern Ops (100M+ Google Play downloads) and Fire Strike (10M+) to onboarding, verification and payment flows. At BrainRocket I worked on 20+ game and gamification projects and ended up as Lead UI Designer. I like to own a feature completely, from how it works and flows to how the final screens look, and I kept designing every day as a lead. AI tools are a normal part of my work: quick exploration, and prototypes in code so the team can try an idea before building it.

KEY RESULTS

- **Team process.** As Lead (May–Sep 2026) I set up regular design reviews and a bi-weekly meeting where we showed work in progress and helped each other with stuck tasks. I kept one roadmap with every designer's projects and tasks, a log of what was done, and all project links (Figma, assets, fonts) in one place. The team was 4–7 designers depending on the period, 4 of them permanent, and I mentored one. We needed fewer iterations, and working with product owners got easier.
- **Starter UI template.** I made a template with the project skeleton and all the generic windows, modals and pop-ups. 4–5 new projects were built on it, adapted rather than copied. I'd estimate it cut setup time by about 30%, and designers and developers came back with fewer questions.
- **Code prototypes with AI agents.** Before a feature went to production, I often built a small working prototype in code. It showed problems early and helped us drop weak ideas before development started. Developers and animators used these prototypes as reference, and we usually needed one or two fewer review rounds with leadership.
- **Season pass.** At EDKON I pushed for a season pass (battle pass) in Modern Ops, back when few mobile shooters had one. Once it was approved, I designed the whole feature, reward economy included. Revenue and retention went up, a big share of players bought it every season, and the studio later added it to all its games, including World War 2 and Fire Strike.

SKILLS

UX flows and interaction design · Onboarding, progression, rewards and retention features · Shop, offers, purchases, KYC and payment flows · Mobile-first UI, high-fidelity visual design, iconography, UI animation · Design systems, reusable components and templates in Figma · Prototyping in Figma and in code with AI agents · Game UI for core and meta (lobby, HUD, season pass / battle pass, events) · Implementation review with developers (Unity) · Design reviews, mentoring, team planning

EXPERIENCE

BrainRocket — Lead UI Designer May 2026 – Sep 2026

BrainRocket — Senior Game UI/UX Designer Dec 2023 – May 2026

20+ game, gamification and interactive projects · mobile and desktop

- Designed UI/UX for products at very different stages, some still concepts, some already live.
- Often got briefs with gaps. I found what was missing, asked the right people, and turned them into flows, prototypes and production-ready screens.
- Built reusable UI systems and components. Also wrote an art brief template for the artists, so they had fewer questions and hit the target more often on the first try.
- Designed KYC verification and payment flows for one of the products.

- Built working prototypes in code with AI agents (Claude, Codex). Used generative tools for exploration, asset variations and short video, and finished everything by hand.
- Worked closely with product, game design, art and developers every day, and checked the implementation myself.
- As Lead: design reviews and bi-weekly team sessions for 4–7 designers, team roadmap and task planning, mentoring, visual direction, while still designing.

EDKON Games — Game UI/UX Designer / Game Designer 2018 – 2023

Modern Ops (100M+ Google Play downloads), Fire Strike (10M+) · Unity

- Designed UI/UX for core and meta systems: onboarding, progression, shop and offers, lobby, HUD and multiplayer flows.
- Proposed and designed the season pass for Modern Ops, plus other monetisation improvements.
- Rebuilt the lobby with fewer sub-pages, so every function had its own clear place.
- Worked on progression, economy and balance with the game designers, and reviewed UI in Unity together with developers.

Fgfactory — UI/UX Designer 2017 – 2018

UI/UX for games and digital products

Unit Space — UI/UX Designer 2017

UI/UX for web and mobile products

TOOLS

Figma, Photoshop, After Effects, Unity (UI review), Jira · Illustrator (working knowledge)
AI: Claude, Codex, ChatGPT, Gemini, Figma AI, Lovable · Midjourney, Nano Banana, Krea, Firefly · Runway, Kling, Veo

LANGUAGES

English — B2 (professional and technical communication) · Ukrainian — fluent · Russian — native